

The Ten Commandments Of Upgrading

1. DON'T upgrade unnecessary stuff. Upgrade only what you really need. When going in for an upgrade, there is always the temptation factor involved—"if I'm going to upgrade this, how about getting a new hard disk as well? That will make my computer spanking new..." Avoid the temptation.
2. DO look at market price forecasts. You'll often see that something is expected to come down, in terms of price, within a few months. Wait. You can save a lot of money this way. Looking to buy a DVD-Writer? Check the current price, and also check how and whether prices will dip in, say, three months from now.
3. DO remember what kind of software you'll be running while doing the hardware upgrade. Will the RAM be sufficient? Will the processor be fast enough? It may seem as though we're contradicting what we said above, about avoiding the temptation to upgrade more than necessary. But what we're saying here is, don't follow the herd when you're on the upgrade path. Look at your requirements from the software point of view as well. If everyone is upgrading to SATA hard drives, for example, don't do it unless you really need one. On the other hand, if you do a lot of processor-intensive work, go for a really fast processor.
4. DO remember your hardware limitations while doing a software upgrade. This is a complementary to what we said earlier. If you're thinking of upgrading to XP and you don't have enough RAM—and can't afford it right now—don't do the upgrade. If you're upgrading to Photoshop CS, check the processor and RAM requirements before you do.

